institutional memory rather than let crucial experiences get carried away into retirement in individual memories. This requires experts in departments to document their knowledge, especially as they get ready to leave. Indeed, one could visualize a process of documentation and debriefing as an essential part of the transfer process. We also need to streamline all our forms and put the bulk of filing online, with unique customer ids so that repetitive filling of common details is eliminated. Finally, we need to adhere to timelines. We are in the process of tracking response times. We hope to see concrete measures during the coming year on bringing them down where necessary.

CULTURE OF COMPLIANCE

It has often been said that India is a weak state. Not only are we accused of not having the administrative capacity of ferreting out wrongdoing, we do not punish the wrongdoer – unless he is small and weak. This belief feeds on itself. No one wants to go after the rich and well-connected wrongdoer, which means they get away with even more. If we are to have strong sustainable growth, this culture of impunity should stop. Importantly, this does not mean being against riches or business, as some would like to portray, but being against wrongdoing.

As the premier and most respected regulator in the country, we should take the lead. We have motivated staff with the highest integrity at every level. Yet there is a sense that we do not enforce compliance. Are we allowing regulated entities to get away year after year with poor practices even though these are noted during inspections/scrutinies? Should we become more intolerant of sloppy practices at regulated entities, so that these do not result in massive scams years later? Should we haul up accountants who do not flag issues they should detect? My sense is that we need a continuing conversation about tightening both detection as well as penalties for